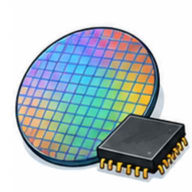
ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Semiconductor English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers.

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

02 Lithography, Reticles, and Critical Dimensions

Clarify missing information before responding.

03 Deposition, Etch, CMP, and Process Windows

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

04 Metrology, SPC, and Yield Learning

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

05 Defect Density and Cleanroom Contamination

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

06 Equipment Uptime, Recipes, and Tool Matching

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

07 Packaging, Test, and Reliability Qualification

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Foundry, Tape-Out, PDK, and Capacity Communication

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 · Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 · Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A new colleague confuses wafer fabrication with packaging. A process overview needs to explain where the current work takes place.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: wafer, fab, process flow, node.

Model response

Wafer fabrication forms devices on the wafer; packaging happens later in the product flow. Our update concerns the fabrication stage. I'll show the relevant process steps before discussing the issue.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.

2. B - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 · Conversations

1. Our work is in the fab, not packaging - Fictional onboarding: a new manufacturing planner confuses wafer fabrication with packaging and asks where the process-integration team works.

2. A lot traveler is not a circuit drawing - Fictional fab induction: a planner sees a lot traveler and mistakes its operation sequence for the product's circuit layout.

3. Wafer completion does not mean shipment readiness - Fictional planning meeting: a wafer lot has completed its listed fab operations, but downstream test and packaging status are unknown.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A process-flow slide skips inspection

A fictional training slide shows deposition followed by etch. The approved route includes an inspection between them. A new planner thinks the slide authorizes skipping inspection. Explain an overview versus an operational route.

Role A: Process-integration engineer: explain the slide's limited teaching purpose.

Role B: Manufacturing planner: ask which controlled record determines the actual sequence.

Possible opening: The slide simplifies the flow for orientation; it does not replace the approved lot route.

Success checks

- Distinguish an overview from controlled manufacturing instructions.

- Avoid authorizing an operational change.

- Agree to confirm the actual route with its owner.

Add a complication: The planner says the shorter slide must be the newer process.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Lithography, Reticles, and Critical Dimensions

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A lithography review reports a critical-dimension shift but does not identify the layer or measurement conditions.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: lithography, photoresist, reticle, critical dimension.

Model response

Which layer and measurement conditions does the shift refer to? Please include the target, observed result, and reference recipe so we can discuss the same comparison.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 · Conversations

1. Which layer shows the CD shift? - Fictional lithography review using the lesson case: a critical-dimension shift is reported without a layer or measurement conditions.

2. The reticle revision is missing - Fictional pattern review: two wafer images are compared, but only one image has a reticle revision recorded.

3. A wafer average without measurement locations - Fictional metrology discussion: a report gives one average critical dimension for a wafer but omits the measurement-site map.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Nanometers or a relative percentage?

A fictional lithography slide labels a shift as 3 without a unit. The underlying measurement table has not been retrieved. Clarify whether this is a dimensional value, percentage, or other measure before interpreting it.

Role A: Process reviewer: request the unit, reference, layer, and measurement stage.

Role B: Report author: acknowledge the missing label and commit to checking the source.

Possible opening: Could you clarify what the value three measures and which reference it is compared with?

Success checks

- Do not infer the missing unit.

- Request the measurement context and reference.

- Keep significance and cause unconfirmed until the source is checked.

Add a complication: A manager asks you to assume nanometers because the meeting concerns critical dimensions.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Deposition, Etch, CMP, and Process Windows

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A process change improves one measured outcome but has not been checked across the proposed operating range.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: deposition, etch, CMP, process window.

Model response

The result is encouraging at the tested settings. We have not established the wider process window. I'll distinguish the observed improvement from the conditions that still need evaluation.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. A - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

2. C - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. A better center point is not a process window - Fictional process review using the lesson case: a change improves one measured outcome at one setting but has not been checked across the proposed range.

2. A smoother surface with an open thickness question - Fictional CMP evaluation: one polished sample shows lower measured roughness, but remaining-film thickness has not been assessed.

3. An etch result after two changes - Fictional engineering trial: both the incoming deposited film and the etch condition changed; a profile measurement improved.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The edge sites are still unmeasured

A fictional deposition trial meets its target at center-wafer sites. Edge sites were not measured, and no full-wafer claim has been assessed. Discuss the result and a request for further evidence without changing a recipe.

Role A: Deposition engineer: state that measured center sites meet the target and identify the unmeasured edge sites.

Role B: Integration reviewer: ask what remains unknown about spatial performance.

Possible opening: The measured center sites meet the target, but the edge sites are still unmeasured.

Success checks

- Limit the finding to measured sites.

- Distinguish missing evidence from a failed result.

- Agree an evaluation question for the responsible owner.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to title the slide Full-wafer improvement confirmed.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Metrology, SPC, and Yield Learning

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

A pilot lot has 92% yield compared with 90% in a reference lot. The sample sizes and product mix differ.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: metrology, SPC, yield, excursion.

Model response

The pilot's reported yield is two percentage points higher. The lots differ in size and mix, so the comparison needs qualification. I'll show those details alongside the headline result.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. C - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

2. B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 · Conversations

1. Ninety-two percent is not yet a matched improvement - Fictional yield review using the lesson case: a pilot lot has 92% yield versus 90% for a reference lot; sample sizes and product mix differ.

2. An SPC signal awaits investigation - Fictional monitoring handoff: an SPC chart flags one point for review; the measurement record is available, but the process investigation has not begun.

3. A measurement rerun is complete, the yield analysis is not - Fictional yield-learning project: a corrected metrology report is ready, but its relationship to final test yield has not been analyzed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The denominator excludes untested dies

A fictional pilot report lists 96 passes out of 100 tested dies. Twenty additional dies have not been tested. A colleague calls the whole group 96% passing. Explain the completed test result and pending coverage.

Role A: Yield analyst: state the tested denominator and the untested count.

Role B: Program manager: ask what can be said about all 120 dies.

Possible opening: The ninety-six percent rate applies to the hundred tested dies, not all one hundred twenty.

Success checks

- Preserve the tested denominator.

- Distinguish untested from passing.

- Agree a follow-up for missing test coverage.

Add a complication: The manager asks to count untested dies as passes because no failures were recorded.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Defect Density and Cleanroom Contamination

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A contamination review needs the timing and location of observed particles. The current note says only "cleanroom problem."

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: defect density, particle, cleanroom, contamination control.

Model response

Could you provide the observation time, location, and relevant records? A precise description will help the team investigate without assuming a contamination source before reviewing the evidence.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. Replace cleanroom problem with location and time - Fictional contamination review using the lesson case: a note says only cleanroom problem and lacks particle timing and location.

2. More particles on a larger inspected area - Fictional inspection comparison: one record lists 12 particles over twice the inspected area of a record listing 8; methods have not been compared.

3. A photo without an observation timestamp - Fictional cleanroom review: a particle image is attached to an issue, but the upload date is the only recorded time.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Before or after the cleaning event?

A fictional particle report and a cleaning record share a date, but neither includes a usable time. No causal link has been established. Request evidence that could clarify the sequence without issuing contamination-control instructions.

Role A: Contamination reviewer: ask for original observation and cleaning records.

Role B: Shift coordinator: identify the missing sequence and contact the record owners.

Possible opening: The records share a date, but we cannot yet tell whether the observation preceded the cleaning.

Success checks

- Avoid inferring sequence from a shared date.

- Request specific original timing evidence.

- Keep source attribution unconfirmed.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to describe cleaning as the confirmed contamination source.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Equipment Uptime, Recipes, and Tool Matching

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

CASE

Two tools run the same nominal recipe but show different measured results. A team member assumes their performance is interchangeable.

Teach this move

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Vocabulary to check: tool uptime, preventive maintenance, recipe, tool matching.

Model response

The recipe name is the same, but the observed results differ. Let's compare the controlled settings and qualification evidence before describing the tools as matched for this process.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. 'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Second-round challenge

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Language-check answers

1. A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less. 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

2. C - An increase of one percentage point. Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

05 · Conversations

1. The same recipe name does not establish tool matching - Fictional equipment comparison using the lesson case: two tools run the same nominal recipe but produce different measured results.

2. Uptime measured with different exclusions - Fictional equipment report: one tool's uptime excludes preventive-maintenance hours, while another report includes those hours in its denominator.

3. A maintained tool versus an unreviewed backup - Fictional scheduling review: tool A has completed preventive maintenance but awaits post-maintenance review; backup tool B is available but matching status is unknown.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Identical recipe names, different revisions

Two fictional tools display recipe name R7, but one record lists revision 2 and the other revision 3. Output comparison has not been performed. Discuss what must match before claiming interchangeability.

Role A: Equipment engineer: explain the identifier difference.

Role B: Production planner: ask for comparable configuration and performance evidence.

Possible opening: The displayed recipe names match, but their revision records differ, so interchangeability remains unconfirmed.

Success checks

- Separate recipe name from revision identity.
- Avoid treating newer as automatically qualified.
- Agree a records and performance review before allocation.

Add a complication: A colleague says the newer revision must be suitable for every tool.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Packaging, Test, and Reliability Qualification

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A package passes one reliability test while two planned tests remain open. A customer slide calls qualification complete.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: package, binning, burn-in, qualification.

Model response

One test is complete; two are still open. I'll report the results by test and avoid describing the overall qualification as complete until the responsible team confirms the required evidence.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. One reliability pass with two tests open - Fictional package review using the lesson case: one reliability test passed, two planned tests remain open, and a slide calls qualification complete.

2. A burn-in result is not every reliability result - Fictional device review: the recorded burn-in test passed, but the rest of the qualification matrix has not been reviewed in this meeting.

3. Different bins do not explain the cause - Fictional final-test review: a package lot has more units in a lower performance bin than a reference lot; test-condition comparability is unverified.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The report covers another package configuration

A fictional qualification report names package configuration P1. The proposed customer part uses P2. The relationship between configurations has not been reviewed. Discuss applicability without assuming either equivalence or failure.

Role A: Package engineer: identify the configuration mismatch.

Role B: Customer quality coordinator: ask who can review whether evidence applies.

Possible opening: The report covers P1; we still need an applicability review for the proposed P2 configuration.

Success checks

- Name the evidence boundary.

- Keep equivalence unconfirmed rather than claiming failure.

- Route applicability to the qualification owner.

Add a complication: A colleague says similar external dimensions prove equivalent qualification.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Foundry, Tape-Out, PDK, and Capacity Communication

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

CASE

A customer requests an earlier tape-out slot. Design checks are still open, and foundry capacity is limited.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

Vocabulary to check: foundry, tape-out, PDK, capacity allocation.

Model response

We can review the earlier slot, but the open design checks and capacity need confirmation. Could we agree on a decision point that reflects both readiness and the foundry's available schedule?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Second-round challenge

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Language-check answers

1. B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule. The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

2. A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope. This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

05 · Conversations

1. An earlier tape-out slot remains conditional - Fictional foundry negotiation using the lesson case: a customer requests an earlier tape-out slot, design checks are open, and capacity is limited.

2. A new PDK version before submission - Fictional design handoff: a team has checks against PDK version 6, while a proposed slot refers to version 7; applicability is unconfirmed.

3. Splitting a request does not create capacity - Fictional capacity discussion: a customer proposes splitting one manufacturing request into two smaller requests; available foundry capacity has not been confirmed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A slot offer expires before a readiness review

A fictional foundry offers a provisional slot with a response requested Thursday. The design-readiness review is Friday, and open checks remain. The liaison cannot approve capacity or waive checks. Negotiate a clarification or timing alternative.

Role A: Customer program manager: explain the mismatch and request an option.

Role B: Foundry liaison: offer to ask about an extension or later slot without guaranteeing either.

Possible opening: The requested response precedes our readiness review, so we cannot yet confirm that the design meets the slot conditions.

Success checks

- Keep open checks visible.

- Offer conditional alternatives within your authority.

- Agree who will confirm readiness and capacity separately.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to describe the open checks as administrative details.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

Open this course's AI prompt workshop

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Semiconductor English

Professional audience: semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Lesson 01: Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

Original fictional case: A new colleague confuses wafer fabrication with packaging. A process overview needs to explain where the current work takes place.

Language workshop: Make a complex point clear

Communication goal: Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Language guidance: Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): In this context, ... means ... . / The difference is that ... . / How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Vocabulary: wafer: Thin semiconductor substrate, usually silicon, on which integrated circuits are fabricated. / fab: Semiconductor fabrication facility where wafers are processed through manufacturing steps. / process flow: Ordered sequence of semiconductor manufacturing steps, layers, inspections, holds, and decision points. / node: Technology generation or process family, often associated with feature size, performance, density, and design rules.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Wafer fabrication forms devices on the wafer; packaging happens later in the product flow. Our update concerns the fabrication stage. I'll show the relevant process steps before discussing the issue.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.

2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.

3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.

4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.

5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Semiconductor English

Professional audience: semiconductor process engineers, yield engineers, product engineers, equipment engineers, fab supervisors, quality teams, test and packaging teams, foundry coordinators, supply planners, applications engineers, and technical program managers

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Lesson 01: Wafer Fabrication Flow and Process Integration

Original fictional case: A new colleague confuses wafer fabrication with packaging. A process overview needs to explain where the current work takes place.

Language workshop: Make a complex point clear

Communication goal: Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Language guidance: Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): In this context, ... means ... . / The difference is that ... . / How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Vocabulary: wafer: Thin semiconductor substrate, usually silicon, on which integrated circuits are fabricated. / fab: Semiconductor fabrication facility where wafers are processed through manufacturing steps. / process flow: Ordered sequence of semiconductor manufacturing steps, layers, inspections, holds, and decision points. / node: Technology generation or process family, often associated with feature size, performance, density, and design rules.

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Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Wafer fabrication forms devices on the wafer; packaging happens later in the product flow. Our update concerns the fabrication stage. I'll show the relevant process steps before discussing the issue.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.

2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.

3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.

4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.

5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level